

# THE CRIMSON DAWN

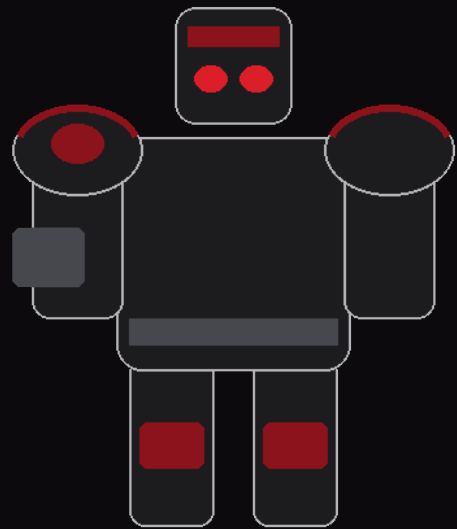
RENEGADE ADEPTUS ASTARTES - FLEET-BASED - RECORDS SEALED

## CHAPTER BADGE



Gothic storm-cloud, crimson with white edge. Displayed on the RIGHT shoulder.

## LIVERY CALLOUT



- 1 Helmet stripe / pauldron trim / kneepads = deep crimson
- 2 Plate = matte charcoal-black + cold grey edges
- 3 Right pad badge = crimson cloud, white outline
- 4 Lenses = glowing red | 5 Weapons = dark gunmetal
- 6 Base = scorched rock / dark earth

## COLOUR SWATCHES



**Charcoal Black**  
Primary armour



**Deep Crimson**  
Trim / badge / stripe



**Cold Grey**  
Edge highlights



**Dark Gunmetal**  
Weapons / metal



**Lens Red**  
Eye lenses



**Scorched Earth**  
Basing

## CHAPTER DATA

|               |                                                                       |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FORMER NAME   | The Umbral Wardens                                                    |
| STATUS        | Renegade; officially missing / sealed-file                            |
| COMMAND       | Dawnlord Dolor                                                        |
| FLAGSHIP      | Ortus Cruentus ("Bloody Dawn")                                        |
| BATTLE-CRY    | "Pain teaches. Dawn follows."                                         |
| GENE-SEED     | Unknown (Imperial rumours conflict wildly)                            |
| COMMAND MARKS | Squad leaders use unique accents/symbols; core black-crimson retained |

## DOCTRINE & ORIGIN

### ORIGIN

Once a quiet-war brotherhood tasked with sealed archives and suppression work, the Umbral Wardens breached a Mechanicus quarantine vault on Mars and recovered a Terran archaeotech data-casket later classed as memetic contraband. Librarius reconstruction produced a fragmentary pre-Imperial parable of outcast cadres who sought peace through shared suffering and decisive force. Senior command accepted the reading as recovered doctrine. When Mars ordered the casket destroyed, the Chapter refused, fled Sol custody, and struck the Aquila.



### THE INCOMPLETE SCRIPTURE

What survives of the casket is badly truncated and biased toward the outcast cadre. Opposing voices are absent or scrambled. The remaining verses culminate in the annihilation of a fortified settlement - and then stop. There is no restoration, no counter-argument, no aftermath. The Dawn read that silence as proof: ruin is the completed lesson. They hunt further fragments believing the Throne hid the rest.

### CREED

- Peace bought by ignorance is a lie
- Shared pain ends cycles of war
- Institutions that farm conflict must break
- Settlement-ruin is proof, not tragedy
- The Emperor is rejected as living god
- Skulls honour cost; eagles mark false order

### IMPERIAL STANDING

- Public rolls: missing / records sealed
- Mechanicus: quiet recovery or burn order
- Inquisition: need-to-know black warrants
- No open crusade branding
- Most citizens never hear the name
- Hunters know; sermons do not

### STRUCTURE & WARFARE

Codex companies give way to a cell network: Dawnlord above, Ring-Bearers as named lieutenants, Cloud Cells as independent kill-cadres. Preferred method - sudden appearance, local overwhelm, symbolic destruction of Imperial command icons, withdrawal before a crusade can consolidate. They leave parables of pain, not occupations.



*"The casket never should have been opened. It never should have survived. It did both."*